UNIT 2

Health Care Delivery System in India

F7YDJ7

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

At the end of the unit, the students will gain adequate knowledge regarding the health care delivery system in our country.

- understand the levels of health care available to the public
- implement the care needed based on the type
- appreciate the essential concept of health, illness and the continuum
- explore the nature of disease pattern
- identify the factors influencing and affecting health
- extrapolate the steps of nursing process and incorporate in the client's need

2.1 Introduction

Health is a fundamental human right and public right. Hence it implies that the state authority has a responsibility for the health of its people. Also we are aware that social, economical, political and environmental factors have an impact on the health care delivery system of any country because it influence growth and development of that particular country. National government of all the countries around the globe are striving to improve and expand their health care delivery services. Nearly all governments of the world have recognized these principles. The current drawback is that they are, urban oriented, curative in nature and it is accessible only to a limited population.

In country like India, health care is completely a government affair. Since independence, India has created a vast public health infrastructure comprising of several sub centres, public health centres, community health centres. It is estimated that this vast infrastructure is benefitted to only 20% of the population and the remaining 80% of the health care needs are still being provided by the private health sectors. A health system also sometimes referred as health care system is the organization of people, institution and resources that deliver health care services to meet the health needs of the people.

In the past most individuals and societies viewed good health or wellness as the opposite or absence of disease. Health is

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